INCH-POUND

MIL-PRF-38120B
15 June 1997
SUPERSEDING
MIL-I-38120A
8 March 1963

PERFORMANCE SPECIFICATION

INDICATOR, RATE OF FLOW AND TRANSFER EFU-20/A

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one type of in-flight refueling rate of flow and fuel transfer indicator, designated EFU-20/A.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2. Government documents

2.2.1 Specifications, standards and handbooks. The following specifications, standards and handbooks form part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: SA-ALC/TILDD, 485 Quentin Roosevelt Road, Kelly AFB, TX 78241-6424 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

SPECIFICATIONS

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE

MIL-C-5015	Connector, Electrical, Circular Threaded, AN Type, General Specification for
MIL-PRF-25439	Transmitter, Rate of Flow, In-Flight Refueling, 0-10,000 PPM, Type MB-3

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-595	Colors Used in Government Procurement

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE

MIL-STD-461	Control of Electromagnetic Interference Emissions and Susceptibility, Requirements for the
MS33558	Numerals and Letters, Aircraft Instrument Dial, Standard Form of
MS33639	Cases, Instrument, Clamp-Mounted, Aircraft

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of Federal and Military Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.3 Order of Precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, (except for related associated detail specifications, specification sheets, or MS standards), the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. This specification provides for first article testing. (see paragraph 4.1 and 4.2).

3.2 Function. The indicator shall be designed as a combined amplifier-indicator to indicate the rate of flow in pounds per minute (ppm) by means of an index type pointer moving around the periphery of the dial from 400 to 10,000 ppm. Fuel consumed from 0 to 999,000 pounds shall be indicated by a cyclometer register located in the central part of the dial. When

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used in conjunction with a type MB-3 transmitter conforming to MIL-PRF-25439 the indicator shall operate with an input voltage of 1 volt per 1,000 ppm fuel flow rate.

3.3. Design and Construction.

3.3.1 Power requirements. The indicator shall be designed to operate from a 115 volt, 400 hertz, single phase power supply. The voltage and frequency may vary together or independently ± 5%. The total power consumption of the indicator shall not exceed 30 va.

3.3.2 Anticreep provisions. The indicator shall incorporate anti-creep provisions for low flow rates which shall exhibit the following characteristics:

a. As the fuel flow rate input signal increases from zero, the counter servo shall be energized when the fuel flow rate is between 200 and 290 ppm.

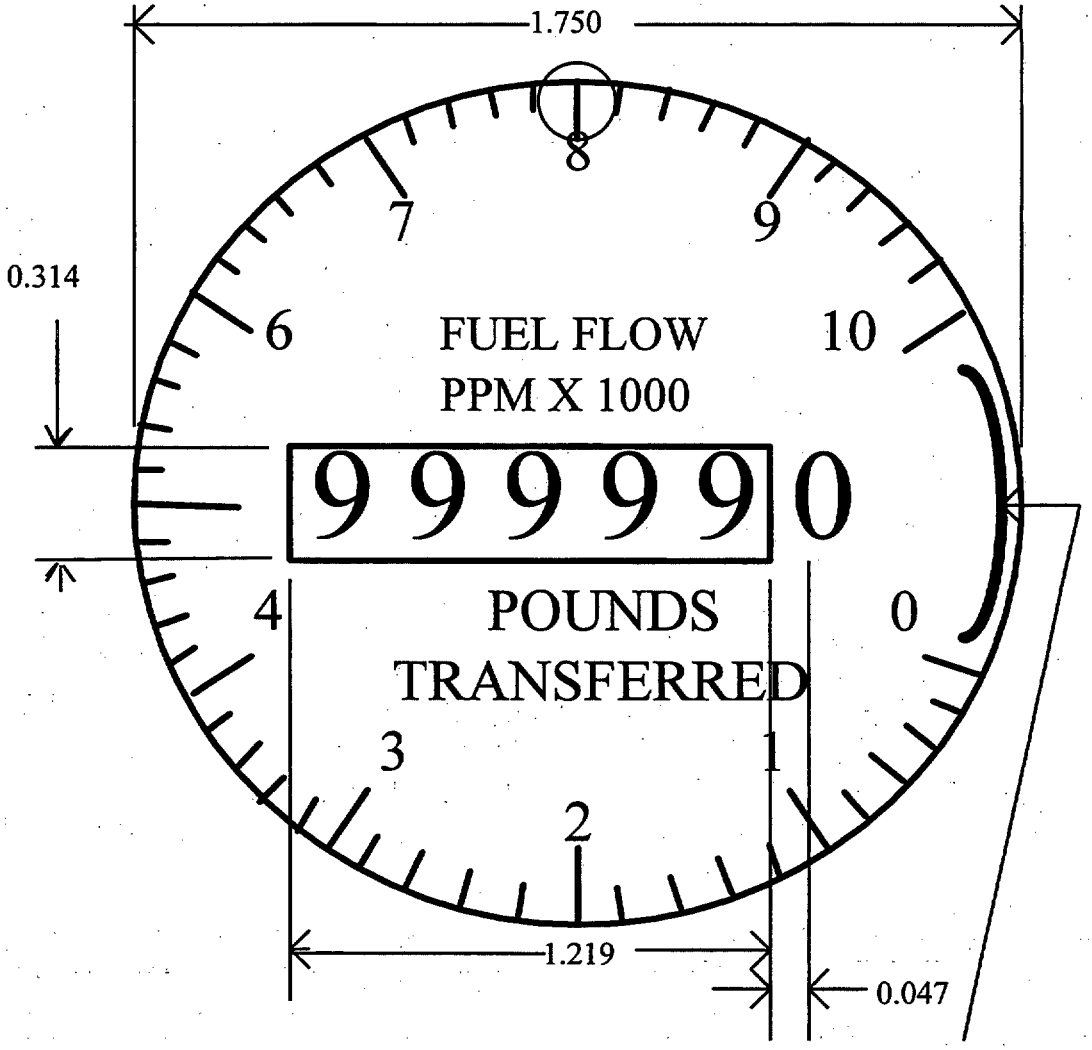
b. As the fuel flow rate decreases from a value above 290 ppm, the counter servo shall become deenergized when the flow rate is between 180 and 125 ppm.

3.3.3 Case. The indicator case shall conform to MS33639, shall be hermetically sealed and shall be finished in durable dull black in accordance with color Number 37038 of FED-STD-595. The front edge of the case shall not extend beyond the outer surface of the cover glass by more than 0.03125 inch. The case length shall not exceed 7.8125 inches, exclusive of the electrical receptacle. The case shall be designed so that the internal mechanism may be removed from the case, replaced, and the case resealed without the use of special tools.

3.3.3.1 Filling medium. The filling medium shall be of at least 98% purity, free of dust particles and shall not contain more than 0.006 milligram of water vapor per liter (dew point - 65° C) at the filling pressure. The filling medium shall be either 100% helium or a mixture of 88 to 92% nitrogen and the remainder helium. The absolute pressure of the filling medium in the case shall be between 1 and 0.5 atmosphere. A tube or other facility for evacuating and filling the case shall be provided at the rear of the case and shall be recessed beneath the level of the back plate surface.

3.3.4 Dial. The indicator dial shall conform to Figure 1. The style and proportions of numerals and letters placed on the dial shall conform to MS33558 except for the counter numerals. Numerals shall distinctly indicate the graduations to which they apply. The dial, pointer and counter markings shall be finished in a fluorescent-luminescent material. All markings shall be permanently and legibly marked.

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Dimensions in inches
Tolerances ± 0.005

USAF TYPE EFU-20/A
(LOCATION OPTIONAL)

	Height or Length Inches	Width of line or Graduations
Scale numerals 0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	0.156	0.020
Major Graduations	0.156	0.020
200 pound Graduations	0.094	0.016
Lettering "FUEL FLOW"and "PPM X 1000"	0.062	0.016
Lettering "POUNDS TRANSFERRED"	0.094	0.020
Counter numerals	0.188 by 0.125	

Figure 1

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3.3.4.1 Index pointer. The length of the pointer shall not overlap more than two-thirds of the shortest graduation, and a support ring, if used, shall not exceed the length of the largest graduation nor overlap any of the scale numbers.

3.3.4.2 Cover glass. The cover glass of the dial shall be clear, flat and free from flaws which interfere with the reading of the instrument. The glass shall not be fluorescent when exposed to ultraviolet light or rays in the 365 millimicron region.

3.3.4.3 Pointer stops. Pointer stops shall be used to limit pointer travel to 0.125 inch beyond each end of the scale.

3.3.5 Electrical receptacle. The indicator shall be provided with an MS33678-18S-1P hermetically sealed receptacle in accordance with MIL-C-5015.

3.3.5.1 Adapter receptacle. An adapter electrical receptacle, wired as shown on Figure 2, shall be furnished with each indicator. This adapter shall be used in lieu of the amplifier component on existing installations. When the combined indicator-amplifier package specified herein is used in the system, the external wiring diagram shown on Figure 2 shall be used for existing in-flight refueling systems. New aircraft instrument systems shall not require the adapter receptacle and shall be wired in accordance with Figure 3.

3.3.6 Transistors and diodes. Transistors and diodes used in the construction of the indicator shall be so designed to allow for continuous operation at a 70° C ambient temperature. Circuit design shall be such that no electronic component will be operated outside its rated characteristics with 115 V ± 10%, 400 Hertz ± 10% power input and with indicator input signals as specified herein.

3.3.7 Regulated voltages. Regulated voltages, if required, shall be obtained from controlled sources within the indicator. Batteries or standard cells shall not be used.

3.3.8 Reset. Reset shall be accomplished electrically by reversing the direction of the motor and causing the counter to move all numerals to zero. This may be accomplished by means of the external switch shown on Figures 2 and 3.

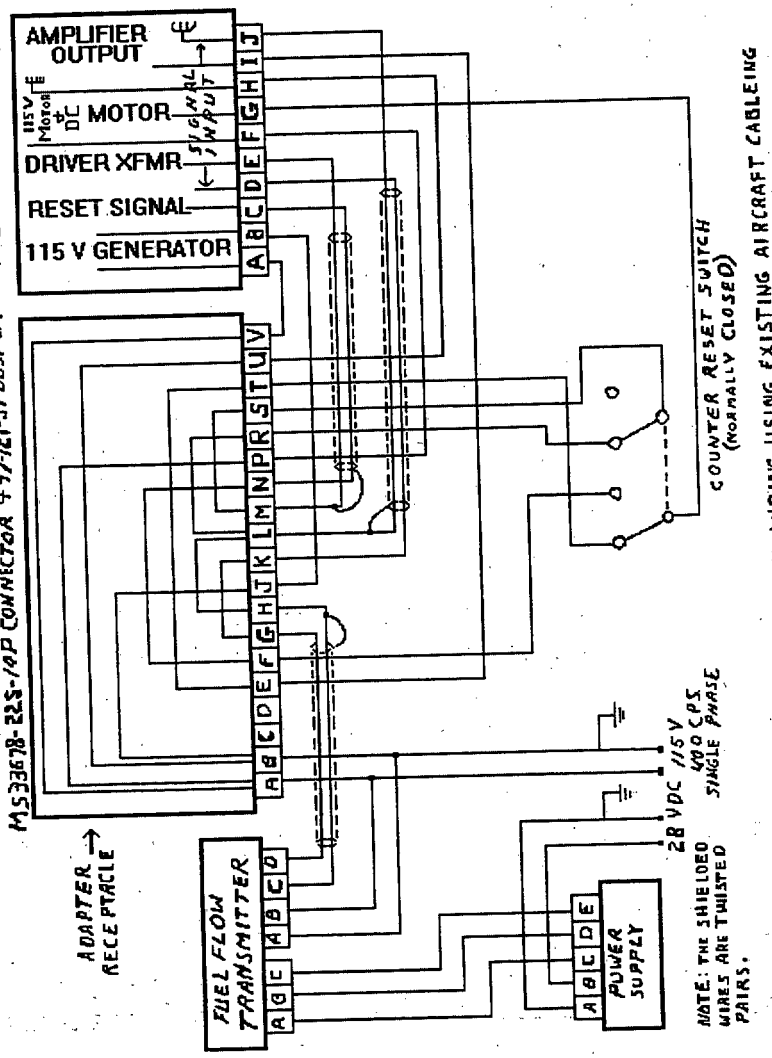
3.3.9 Temperature compensation. The indicator shall be automatically and internally temperature compensated for the range of -54° to +71° C.

3.3.10 Weight. The weight of the indicator shall not exceed 2.25 pounds.

3.4 Performance. The indicator shall be capable of meeting the requirements specified herein when subjected to the following conditions:

a. Temperature - Temperatures within the range of -54° to +71° C.

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ADAPTIVE EXTERNAL WIRING USING EXISTING AIRCRAFT CABLEING

FIGURE 2

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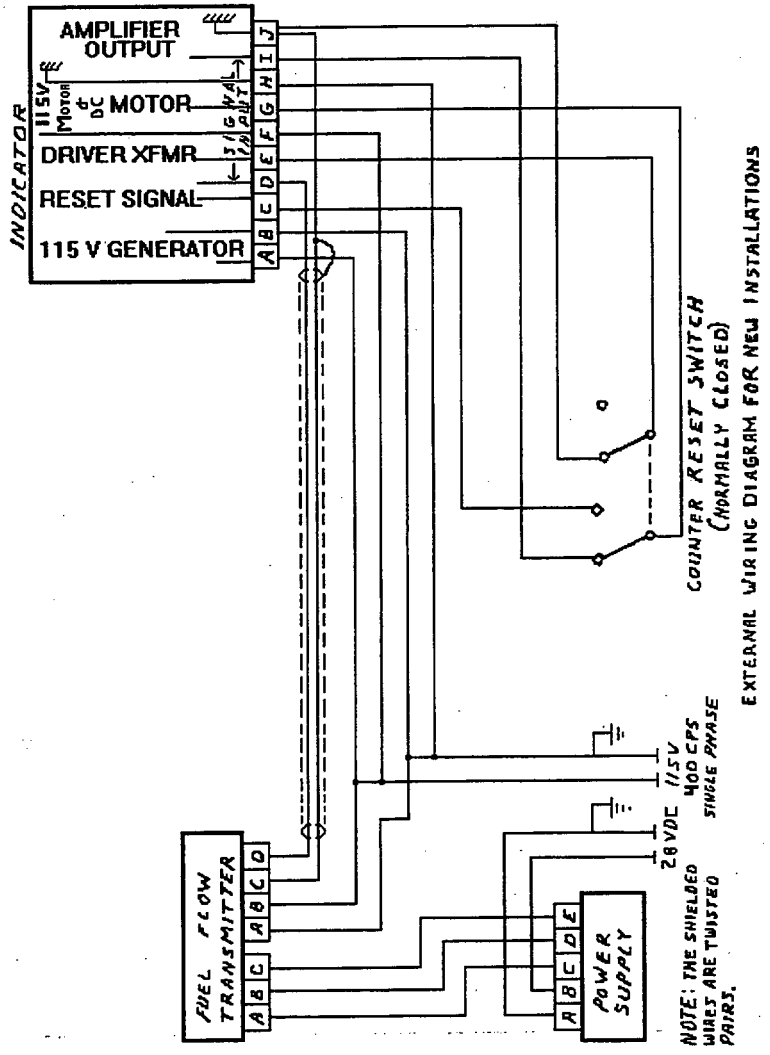


FIGURE 3

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b. Vibration - Vibration for 3 hours at a double amplitude of 0.018 to 0.020 inch and at 500 to 3,000 cpm as specified.

c. Salt spray - Exposure to salt sea atmosphere for a 50 hour period.

d. Thermal Shock - Alternate immersion for 30 minutes in water at +85° C and at +5° C for 8 cycles at specified in Section 4.

3.4.1 Radio Noise. Internally radiated and conducted radio noise shall meet the requirements of MIL-STD-461, Emission and Susceptibility Requirements CE102 and RE102.

3.4.2 Endurance. The indicator shall be capable of withstanding 1,200 hours of operation.

3.4.3 Accuracy. Scale error and friction of rate and total consumed indications shall be within the tolerances specified in Tables I, II, and III.

3.4.4 Response. The indicator shall show a rate indication from zero to full scale or from full scale to zero in less than 2 seconds. Counter response shall be in accordance with Table II.

TABLE I

Scale Error and Friction						
	Tolerances					
Test	Room Temperature		+71° C		-54° C	
Point PPM	Scale Error ±	Friction	Scale Error ±	Friction	Scale Error ±	Friction
500	90	40	120	40	150	60
1,000	50	40	70	40	85	60
2,000	40	40	55	40	70	60
3,000	60	40	80	40	100	60
4,000	80	40	110	40	140	60
5,000	100	40	130	40	170	60
6,000	120	40	160	40	200	60
7,000	140	40	190	40	230	60
8,000	160	40	210	40	270	60
9,000	180	40	240	40	300	60
10,000	200	40	270	40	330	60

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TABLE II

Counter Error				
Rate of Flow Setting PPM	Test Interval Seconds	Mass & Tolerance (lb.) Room Temp	High Temp	Low Temp
1,000	120	2,000 ±50	2,000 ±70	2,000 ±90
3,000	120	6,000 ±100	6,000 ±140	6,000 ±180
6,000*	120	12,000 ±150	12,000 ±240	12,000 ±270
9,000	120	18,000 ±300	18,000 ±420	18,000 ±540

* Test Point (see 4.5.3)

TABLE III

Test Point	Test Interval	Mass Tolerance	Scale Error	Friction
6,000 PPM	120 Seconds	12,000 ±300 lb.	200 PPM	40 PPM
Vibration				
Pointer oscillation			150 ppm	
Pointer variation			150 ppm	
Voltage and Frequency Variation				
Test Point 3,000 PPM			Tolerance 30 PPM	

3.5 Materials. Nonmagnetic and nonferrous materials shall be used for all parts of the indicator, except where such materials are essential. Metals shall be corrosion resistant or suitably treated to resist corrosion. Unless suitably protected against electrolytic corrosion, dissimilar metals shall not be used in intimate contact with one another.

3.5.1 Protective treatment. When materials are used in the indicator that will deteriorate when exposed to climatic and environmental conditions likely to occur during service usage, they shall be protected against such deterioration in a manner that will in no way prevent compliance with the requirements of this specification. The use of any protective coating that will crack, chip or scale with age or the extremes of climatic and environmental conditions shall be avoided.

3.5.2 Recycled, recovered, or environmentally preferable materials. Recycled, recovered, or environmentally preferable materials should be used to the maximum extent possible provided that the material meets or exceeds the operational and maintenance requirements, and promotes economically advantageous life cycle costs.

3.6 Identification plate. An identification plate shall be provided on the rear of the indicator case. Information provided shall include the government designation for the indicator, the manufacturer's part number and the manufacturer's Commercial and Government Entity (CAGE) Code.

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3.7 Workmanship. The indicator shall be constructed and finished in a thoroughly workmanlike manner. Particular attention shall be given to neatness and thoroughness of soldering, wiring, welding, riveting, brazing, plating and painting. All parts shall be free from burrs and sharp edges. Gears shall be of high quality and shall provide a minimum of backlash necessary for smooth operation.

4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see paragraph 4.3).

b. Conformance inspection (see paragraph 4.4).

4.1.2 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified, all inspections shall be performed in accordance with the test conditions specified in 4.2.

4.2 Test conditions.

4.2.1 Atmosphere. Whenever the pressure and temperature existing at the time of the test are not otherwise specified, the test shall be made at atmospheric pressure (29.92 inches Hg) and at room temperature (approximately 25° C). When tests are made with atmospheric pressure or room temperature differing from the above values, proper allowance shall be made for the difference from the specified condition.

4.2.2 Tapping. Unless otherwise specified, the instrument shall be gently tapped or vibrated before a test reading is taken.

4.2.3 Vibration stand. Whenever a vibration stand is specified, the stand shall vibrate at any desired frequency between 500 and 3,000 cpm. The stand shall vibrate the components in such a manner that a point on the case will describe, in a plane inclined 45° to the horizontal plane, a circle as specified herein.

4.2.4 Test position. Unless otherwise specified, the indicator shall be tested with the mounting surfaces in an upright, vertical position.

4.2.5 Master transmitter. The indicator shall be tested with a master transmitter specially designed for the purpose. Tests shall be performed to determine that the transmitted signal is not in error in excess of 0.1%. The output voltage of the master transmitter shall have a magnitude of 1 V/1,000 ppm at a phase angle of 15° ±5° leading the line voltage. Instrument errors due to changes of phase shift in the master transmitter shall be recorded and compensated for in test results.

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4.2.6 Tolerances. Test tolerances shall be as specified in Tables I, II, and III.

4.3 First article. The first article inspection shall consist of all tests described under paragraph 4.5.

4.3.1 Inspection sample. The first article inspection sample shall consist of 2 indicators which are identical in all respects to the indicators that are produced as production items.

4.3.2 First article test report. Upon completion of the first article inspection and tests, a test report shall be prepared in accordance with contractor format. The report shall include the results of the tests conducted as well as checklists used during the testing.

4.4 Conformance inspection. Inspection of indicators shall consist of individual tests and sampling tests.

4.4.1 Individual Tests. Each indicator shall be subjected to the following tests as described under 4.5.

a. Physical examination

b. Dielectric strength

c. Scale error and friction

d. Counter error

e. Electrical characteristics

f. Sealing

4.4.2 Sampling Tests. Unless otherwise specified a minimum of 2 indicators shall be selected at random from each 100 items produced on the contract or order and subjected to all the tests as described under 4.5.

4.4.3 Rejection and Retest. When an item selected from a production run fails to meet the tests of this specification, no items still on hand or later produced shall be accepted until the extent and cause of the failure have been determined and corrected. The contractor shall provide a written explanation as to the cause of the failures and the actions taken to preclude recurrence. After correction, all tests shall be repeated. For production reasons individual tests may be continued pending the investigation of a sampling test failure but final acceptance of these items shall not be made until it is determined that all items meet all the requirements of this specification. If investigation indicates that defects may exist in items already accepted the contractor shall notify the procuring activity of these defects and the method of correcting them.

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4.5 Test Methods.

4.5.1 Physical examination. The indicator shall be inspected to determine compliance with this specification with respect to materials, workmanship, identification and dimensions.

4.5.2 Scale error and friction. The indicator shall be connected to a master transmitter. After the system has operated for 10 minutes, the transmitter shall be so adjusted that when the indicator is at the test point indicated in Table II, the counter time will be 120 ±0.4 second or 180 ±0.6 second, as applicable. The transmitter reading shall be recorded for use in future inspection tests. The master transmitter shall be set at values equivalent to each of the test points in Table I. Two rate-of-flow readings shall be taken, the first before and the second after the instrument is vibrated. The differences between the first and second reading shall not exceed the friction tolerances listed in Table I. The second reading shall not exceed the scale error tolerances specified in Table I.

4.5.3 Counter Error. The fuel flow rates specified in Table II shall be set on the master transmitter. The flow indicated on the counter during the test shall be measured and shall be within the tolerances specified in Table II.

4.5.4 Electrical Characteristics. Electrical tests shall be performed on the indicator and its components to insure satisfactory performance when connected into the flowmeter system. Anticreep tests shall form a part of this testing.

4.5.5 Sealing. The indicator case shall be tested for leaks. Where a nitrogen-helium mixture is utilized as the filling medium, the detected leak rate shall not exceed 0.1 micron cubic foot per hour at a pressure differential of 1 atmosphere. Where 100 % helium is utilized as the filling medium, the leak rate shall not exceed 1.0 micron cubic foot per hour at a pressure differential of 1 atmosphere.

4.5.6 Vibration error. The indicator shall be subjected to vibration at frequencies within the range of 500 to 3,000 cpm in such a manner that the point of the case will describe, in a plane inclined 45° to the horizontal plane, a circle of approximately 0.008 to 0.011 inch diameter. The indicator shall receive a signal from the master transmitter that equals a mid-scale indication. The pointer oscillation and variation shall not exceed the tolerance specified in Table III.

4.5.7 Vibration endurance. The indicator shall be subjected to vibration for a period of 3 hours on a vibration stand so that a point on the indicator will describe, in a plane inclined 45° to the horizontal, a circle 0.018 to 0.020 inch diameter. During the period of vibration, the indicator shall receive a signal from the master transmitter that equals a mid scale indication. The frequency shall be varied from 500 to 3,000 cpm and the pointer action noted for resonant points. If resonance is noted, the indicator shall vibrate at that point for the duration of the test. If the indicator does not indicate any resonance with the frequency range, the frequency shall be set at any point between 2,000 and 3,000 cpm. Following the vibration period, the indicator

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shall be checked for scale error and friction. The scale error and friction shall not exceed room temperature tolerances. No screws or other parts shall become loosened or damaged as a result of vibration.

4.5.8 Frequency and voltage variation. The master transmitter shall be set to the test point listed in Table III. The applied voltage and frequency to the master transmitter and indicator shall be set at the following points:

a. 110 V AC 380 Hertz
b. 110 V AC 420 Hertz
c. 120 V AC 380 Hertz
d. 120 V AC 420 Hertz

When the applied voltage and frequency are changed as specified, the change in combined counter tolerances shall not exceed those specified in Tables II and III.

4.5.9 Low temperature. The indicator, not energized, shall be subjected to a temperature of approximately -54° C for a period of 4 hours. While still at this temperature, the test transmitter shall be set at zero ppm. Power shall be applied to the indicator. At the end of a 10 minute warm-up period, the master transmitter shall be set to the full scale test point. Within 180 seconds, the indicator shall read within the double scale error room temperature tolerances listed in Table I. The indicator shall then meet the low temperature scale error and friction tolerances specified in Table I and the counter error tolerances listed in Table II.

4.5.10 High temperature. The indicator, while energized, shall be subjected to a temperature of approximately 71° C for a period of 4 hours and tested at this temperature for scale errors.. The scale error and friction tolerances for both pointer an counter shall not exceed the tolerances specified in Tables I and II.

4.5.11 Position Error. The scale error and counter error tests shall be repeated at the test point shown in Table III with the instrument turned 90° right, 90° left, face up, and face down. The change in scale error and friction shall not exceed the tolerances specified in Table III.

4.5.12 Fogging. The indicator shall be energized and kept in a 70° ±2° C controlled ambient temperature for a minimum of 1 hour. After this period, and while at this temperature, ice shall be rubbed on the indicator glass face for a period of 1 to 2 minutes. The glass shall then be wiped dry (compressed air shall not be used) and the indicator inspected for evidence of water and oil fog. Evidence of fogging shall be cause for rejection. The test may be accomplished in conjunction with the high temperature and scale error and friction tests.

4.5.13 Low temperature exposure. The indicator shall be exposed to a temperature of approximately -54° C for a 24 hour period. At the completion of this time period, and while still at this temperature, the indicator shall be subjected to the scale error and counter error tests and shall meet the tolerances specified in 4.5.9. The indicator shall then be maintained at room

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temperature for a period of not less than 4 hours and subjected to the scale error at room temperature test. The scale errors observed shall not exceed the specified tolerances. The indicator shall be examined for deterioration or damage due to extreme temperature exposure.

4.5.14 High temperature exposure. The indicator shall be exposed to a temperature of approximately 71° C for a 48 hour period. At the completion of this time period, and while still at this temperature, the indicator shall be subjected to the scale error and counter error tests and shall meet the tolerances specified in 4.5.10. The indicator shall then be maintained at room temperature for a period of not less than 4 hours and subjected to the scale error at room temperature test. The scale errors observed shall not exceed the specified tolerances. The indicator shall be examined for deterioration or damage due to extreme temperature exposure.

4.5.15 Salt spray. The indicator shall be subjected to a salt spray test of approximately 50 hours. The scale error at room temperature test shall be conducted immediately before and after this test. The scale error tolerances after the salt spray test shall not exceed the tolerances obtained before the test. Subsequent indicator operation shall not be affected by this test, and corrosion of metal parts, including electrical receptacles, shall be cause for rejection.

4.5.16 Thermal shock. The indicator shall be subjected to 8 cycles of immersion in water at approximately 85° C and at approximately 5° C as follows: each cycle shall consist of immersing the indicator in water at 85° C for a period of 30 minutes, within 5 seconds removing it from the bath, immersing it in the other water bath maintained at 5° C for a period of 30 minutes, and then within 5 seconds again immersing it in the water at 85° C for a period of 30 minutes. Following this test, the indicator shall be subjected to the sealing test specified in 4.5.5. No leakage shall be detected. There shall be no evidence of moisture penetration nor damage to the indicator as a result of this test.

4.5.17 Endurance. The indicator shall be subjected to 1,200 hours of operation which shall include 100,000 applications of flow signals to produce an indicator from 0 to 85 ±5 % of the system range and back to 0 at a rate of 15 ±10 cpm. The scale error and friction test shall be conducted 1 hour after the completion of the endurance run. The errors shall not exceed the specified tolerances.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When actual packaging of material is to be performed by DoD personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain requisite packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activity within the Military Department or Defense Agency, or within the Military Department's System Command. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

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6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature which may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The EFU-20/A indicator is intended for use in indicating the rate of flow and the amount of fuel transferred during in-flight refueling operations.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents shall specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.

b. Preservation, packaging and packing required.

6.3 Subject term (key word) listing.

Cyclometer Register
Pounds per minute
Tapping
Hermetically sealed
Fuel flow

6.4 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extent of the changes.

Custodian:
Air Force - 99

Preparing Activity:
Air Force - 82

Review Activity:
DLA - GS

Agent Activity
Air Force - 99

(Project 6680-F247)

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2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the

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I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT MIL-PFR-38120B	2. DOCUMENT DATE

3. DOCUMENT
INDICATOR, RATE OF FLOW AND TRANSFER EFU-20/A

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as*

5. REASON FOR

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME *(Last, First, Middle Initial)*	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS *(Include Zip Code)*	d. TELEPHONE *(Include Area Code)* (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON *(If applicable)*	e. DATE SUBMITTED *(YYMMDD)*

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME SA-ALC/TILDD	b. TELEPHONE *(Include Area Code)* (1) Commercial (210) 925-6314 (2) AUTOVON 945-6314
c. ADDRESS *(Include Zip Code)* 485 Quentin Roosevelt Rd. Kelly AFB, TX 78241-6424	**IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT:** Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041- Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-

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